thesis a n d fusion grew the Indian races a n d the basic Indian culture, which had distinctive elements of both. In the ages that followed there came many other races: Iranians, Greeks, Parthians, Bactrians, Scythians, Huns, Turks (before Islam), early Christians, Jews, Zoroastrians; they came, made a difference, and were absorbed. India was, according to Dodwell, 'infinitely absorbent like the ocean.' It is odd to think of India, with her caste system a n d exclusiveness, having this astonishing inclusive capacity to

absorb foreign races and cultures. Perhaps it was due to this that she retained her vitality and rejuvenated herself from time to time. T h e Moslems, when they came, were also powerfully affected by her. ' T h e foreigners (Muslim Turks),' says Vincent Smith, 'like their forerunners the Sakas and the Yueh-chi, universally yielded to the wonderful assimilative power of Hinduism, and rapidly became Hinduised.'

What i s H i n d u i s m ?

In this quotation Vincent Smith has used the words 'Hinduism' and 'Hinduised'. I do not think it is correct to use them in this way unless they are used in the widest sense of Indian culture.